

# Google Gives Robots a Reasoning Brain, Waymo Eyes an Uber Breakup, and Autonomous Freight Scales Up

## TL;DR

- ▶ Google DeepMind launched Gemini Robotics ER 2, a model that lets robots reason and act simultaneously, available now via the Gemini API.
- ▶ Waymo is reportedly exploring a split from Uber, threatening the robotaxi partnership in Austin and Atlanta.
- ▶ Aurora launched second-gen driverless trucks rated for up to 1M miles as it scales autonomous freight across the Sun Belt.

## AI NEWS

*the news — then what it means for you*

**Google DeepMind launched Gemini Robotics ER 2, a new flagship model for humanoid and robot control.** Unlike earlier versions that paused to think between actions, ER 2 reasons and acts simultaneously, tracks task progress through continuous video feeds, and supports multi-robot collaboration; it's available to developers now via the Gemini API.

**What it means for you:** Google is packaging embodied-AI reasoning as an API product, not just a research demo. Worth watching if any client is evaluating robotics or automation vendors, since the underlying model layer may soon be commoditized the way LLMs already are.

Source: Superhuman AI

**Veterans First for America unveiled "Digital DNA," a concept using a 40-sensor haptic suit to capture a person's movements, vital signs, and skills for transfer into a humanoid robot or hologram after death.** Licensing plans reportedly range from \$300,000 for 100 years to \$1M for 500 years; the claims are speculative and have not been independently verified.

**What it means for you:** Treat this as a hype-cycle marker, not a technology to plan around. But the underlying idea, capturing an expert's know-how before they leave, is a real, near-term application worth raising with clients facing retirement waves or key-person risk.

Source: Superhuman AI

**Waymo is reportedly exploring a split from Uber**, threatening the partnership that currently puts its robotaxis on Uber's network in Austin and Atlanta.

**PM angle:** A live example of platform dependency risk. If a client relies on a single distribution partner for a new product line, this is a concrete case to point to.

**Conversation starter:** *If Waymo can walk away from Uber's platform, how exposed are we if our biggest channel partner decided to do the same?*

Source: Superhuman AI

**Aurora launched its second-generation driverless trucks**, built for up to 1 million miles, as part of a plan to scale autonomous freight across 10 US Sun Belt routes.

**PM angle:** Autonomous freight is moving from pilot to fleet scale. Relevant context for any client in logistics, trucking, or supply chain benchmarking automation timelines.

**Conversation starter:** *Aurora's trucks are now rated for a million miles. At what mileage does the ROI case for autonomous freight flip from 'someday' to 'now' for us?*

Source: Superhuman AI

**Robotics research lab Enigma raised \$71M to build more intuitive robot controls**, betting that studying human-robot interaction can make operating robots easier.

**PM angle:** A reminder that the UX layer, not just the model, is where robotics investment is flowing. A useful comparison point when clients frame AI projects as pure model or technology bets.

**Conversation starter:** *Enigma just raised \$71M on the bet that robot UX is the bottleneck, not the AI itself. Are we underinvesting in the interface layer on our own AI projects?*

Source: Superhuman AI

**San Francisco Mayor Daniel Lurie is backing federal robotaxi regulation** after recent Waymo and Zoox breakdowns exposed gaps in emergency-response oversight.

**PM angle:** Regulatory scrutiny of autonomous systems is increasing at the local level first. Relevant if a client operates AI-driven physical products or services that could face similar oversight gaps.

**Conversation starter:** *Local emergency-response gaps are what's driving robotaxi regulation, not the AI itself. Where are the analogous gaps in how we've deployed AI for our own clients?*

Source: Superhuman AI

**Viral footage shows Chinese troops running an urban breach exercise in which quadruped robots enter smoke-filled rooms ahead of soldiers**, part of China's growing "robot wolf" military robotics program.

**PM angle:** No direct relevance to your work, general awareness only.

**Conversation starter:** *Did you see the footage of China's robot dogs leading troops into buildings? Wild how fast military robotics is moving.*

Source: Superhuman AI